

NAVRATRI

A Speech for School Assembly · Five Versions

नवरात्रि — नौ रातों का उत्सव

What is inside

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Colour guide

Red bold italic – CEFR level words (Versions 1–4)

Green bold – phrasal verbs (Version 5)

Each version has an Introduction, Body and Conclusion, followed by a word list with English and Hindi meanings. Word counts include the greeting and closing lines. CEFR levels are indicative, based on common Oxford / CEFR word lists.

VERSION 1 OF 5

CEFR A2 · Elementary

प्राथमिक स्तर

Good morning, respected Principal, honourable teachers and my dear friends.

INTRODUCTION

Today I want to talk about a very **special festival**. It is called Navratri. The word Navratri means "nine nights". People in India **celebrate** this festival every year in **autumn**. It is my **favourite** festival because it is full of music, colour and happiness. I am very happy to share it with you today.

BODY

Navratri is for Goddess Durga. For nine days, people pray to her in different forms. Many families make a small temple at home and light a lamp every morning and evening. Some people eat only simple food, and some do not eat meat. My grandmother keeps a fast and tells us a beautiful story about the goddess.

In the evening, the fun begins. In Gujarat, people wear **colourful** clothes and dance the Garba and Dandiya. Girls wear bright dresses, and boys wear kurtas. We dance in a **circle** with sticks in our hands, and we sing songs together. In other places, like West Bengal, people make big statues of Durga and visit them with their families. Everybody eats **sweets** and meets their friends.

Navratri also teaches us an important **lesson**. The story says that Goddess Durga fights a bad king named Mahishasura, and she wins. So the festival shows us that good always wins over bad. The tenth day is called Dussehra, and it is a day of victory.

CONCLUSION

To finish, Navratri is not only a festival of dance and food. It is also a time to be **kind**, to help other people and to learn from our **culture**. Let us celebrate it with love and keep our homes and streets clean and safe. Thank you very much for listening. Happy Navratri to all of you!

Word count: 290 words

CEFR A2 WORDS USED – ENGLISH & HINDI

#	Word	CEFR	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	festival	A2	A special time when people celebrate something with food, music and events	त्योहार / उत्सव
2	special	A2	Better or different from usual; important	विशेष / खास
3	celebrate	A2	To do something enjoyable on an important day	मनाना / जश्न मनाना
4	autumn	A2	The season between summer and winter	पतझड़ / शरद ऋतु
5	favourite	A2	Liked more than all others	पसंदीदा / प्रिय
6	colourful	A2	Having many bright colours	रंगीन / रंग-बिरंगा
7	circle	A2	A round shape or a group standing in a round shape	गोला / घेरा
8	sweets	A2	Small sugary food items	मिठाइयाँ
9	lesson	A2	Something that you learn from an experience or a story	सबक / सीख
10	kind	A2	Friendly, caring and helpful to others	दयालु / मेहरबान
11	culture	A2	The customs, traditions and ideas of a group of people	संस्कृति

VERSION 2 OF 5

CEFR B1 · Intermediate

मध्यम स्तर

Good morning, respected Principal, kind teachers and my dear friends.

INTRODUCTION

It gives me great pleasure to speak to you today about Navratri, one of the most popular festivals in India. The word means "nine nights", and the festival usually falls in September or October. It is a joyful **occasion** when families, neighbours and friends **gather** to celebrate, to enjoy music and to remember an old and meaningful story.

BODY

Navratri is dedicated to Goddess Durga, and each day honours a different form of her. Many people follow the **tradition** of fasting, and they **pray** at home or in the temple. Families also **decorate** their houses with flowers and lights. This **religious** side of the festival gives people a strong **belief** that they are protected and guided.

However, Navratri is also a great **cultural** event. In Gujarat, the streets and grounds are full of people who dance the Garba and Dandiya until late at night. In Bengal, the festival is known as Durga Puja, and beautiful clay idols are placed in large, decorated tents. Whichever way it is celebrated, the festival strengthens the sense of **community**, because people of every age join together. Grandparents share old stories with children, and that is how each **generation** passes its customs on to the next.

The most important message of Navratri comes from the story of Durga and the demon Mahishasura. Durga fought him for nine days and finally won on the tenth day, which we celebrate as Dussehra. This **victory** is a **symbol** of **courage** and shows that truth always defeats evil. I believe we students can learn from it. We should have the **courage** to speak the truth, to **respect** others and to stand up against unfair behaviour.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, Navratri is much more than music, colour and food. It reminds us of our roots, brings people closer and teaches us values that we need in our daily life. Let us celebrate it with joy and responsibility, and let us promise to follow its good lessons throughout the year. Thank you for listening, and Happy Navratri to all of you!

Word count: 347 words

CEFR B1 WORDS USED – ENGLISH & HINDI

#	Word	CEFR	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	occasion	B1	A particular time or event, especially an important one	अवसर / मौका
2	gather	B1	To come together in one place	इकट्ठा होना / जमा होना
3	tradition	B1	A custom passed down over many years	परंपरा
4	pray	B1	To speak to God or a god, to ask for help or give thanks	प्रार्थना करना
5	decorate	B1	To make something look attractive by adding things to it	सजाना
6	religious	B1	Connected with religion or faith	धार्मिक
7	belief	B1	A strong feeling that something is true or exists	विश्वास / आस्था
8	cultural	B1	Connected with the customs and arts of a society	सांस्कृतिक
9	community	B1	A group of people living in the same area or sharing interests	समुदाय / समाज
10	generation	B1	All the people born at about the same time	पीढ़ी
11	victory	B1	Success in a battle or competition	विजय / जीत
12	symbol	B1	A thing that represents an idea or quality	प्रतीक / चिह्न
13	courage	B1	The ability to face danger or fear without running away	साहस / हिम्मत
14	respect	B1	To show admiration and polite behaviour towards someone	सम्मान करना / आदर करना

VERSION 3 OF 5

CEFR B2 · Upper-Intermediate

उच्च-मध्यम स्तर

A very good morning to our respected Principal, distinguished teachers and my fellow students.

INTRODUCTION

Imagine a country where, for nine nights in a row, the air is filled with drumbeats, devotional songs and the glow of oil lamps. That country is India, and that festival is Navratri. Today I would like to explore what makes this celebration so meaningful, both in a **spiritual** and in a social sense.

BODY

Navratri, which literally means "nine nights", is dedicated to Goddess Durga and her nine forms. Devotees **worship** her with fasting, prayers and offerings, and many families perform a small **ceremony** at home on the first day by planting barley seeds in a clay pot as a sign of new life. There is a great deal of **enthusiasm** in the air, and the preparations often begin weeks in advance.

Behind the festival stands an **ancient legend**. According to tradition, the demon Mahishasura had become so powerful that even the gods could not defeat him. Durga, created from the combined energy of the gods, fought him for nine nights and finally destroyed him on the tenth day. What **inspires** me most about this story is its **moral**: unity, courage and **determination** can overcome even the most powerful and unfair force. The festival also invites us to **reflect** on our own weaknesses. Just as the goddess destroys evil, we should try to remove our own bad habits, such as anger, laziness and pride.

Socially, Navratri brings people from all backgrounds together. The rhythmic circles of Garba and Dandiya in Gujarat, the grand pandals of Durga Puja in Bengal and the Ramlila performances in northern India all show how one festival can take many beautiful forms. Yet the spirit behind them remains the same: joy, faith and a sense of belonging.

CONCLUSION

To sum up, Navratri is a perfect combination of faith, art and community. It encourages us to respect our elders, to protect what is good and to challenge what is wrong. Let us carry this message with us long after these nine nights are over. Thank you for your kind attention, and I wish you all a very Happy Navratri.

Word count: 355 words

CEFR B2 WORDS USED – ENGLISH & HINDI

#	Word	CEFR	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	spiritual	B2	Connected with the human spirit or soul rather than the body	आध्यात्मिक
2	worship	B2	To show respect and love to a god through prayers and rituals	पूजा करना / आराधना करना
3	ceremony	B2	A formal public or religious event	समारोह / अनुष्ठान
4	enthusiasm	B2	A strong feeling of excitement and interest	उत्साह / जोश
5	ancient	B2	Very old; from a time long ago	प्राचीन / पुरातन
6	legend	B2	A very old story that may not be completely true	पौराणिक कथा / किंवदंती
7	inspire	B2	To make someone feel they want to do something good	प्रेरित करना
8	moral	B2	A lesson about right and wrong taught by a story	नैतिक शिक्षा / सीख
9	determination	B2	The firm decision to continue despite difficulties	दृढ़ संकल्प / निश्चय
10	reflect	B2	To think carefully and deeply about something	चिंतन करना / मनन करना

VERSION 4 OF 5

CEFR C1 / C2 · Advanced & Proficient

उन्नत एवं दक्ष स्तर

Good morning to our esteemed Principal, learned faculty and my dear fellow students.

INTRODUCTION

Among the **myriad** festivals that adorn India's cultural calendar, few possess the **profound** significance of Navratri. Spanning nine nights, this **vibrant** celebration is far more than an annual **spectacle**; it is a living expression of a civilisation's collective conscience, in which faith, art and philosophy **converge**.

BODY

At its core, Navratri **venerates** the divine feminine, **embodied** in the nine forms of Goddess Durga. Devotees observe fasts with **unwavering** discipline, and temples across the subcontinent echo with hymns that have been **perpetuated** orally for centuries. Such **reverence** is not blind ritual; rather, it reflects a worldview in which power, or shakti, is understood to be both creative and protective.

The mythological narrative at the heart of the festival, Durga's decisive battle against the buffalo demon Mahishasura, carries an allegory that **transcends** religion. The demon **personifies** arrogance and unchecked ambition, whereas the goddess represents righteous strength. Her **triumph** on the tenth day, commemorated as Dussehra, reminds us that tyranny, however formidable, is ultimately **transient**.

Equally compelling is the festival's **kaleidoscope** of regional expressions. From the exuberant Garba circles of Gujarat to the artistic pandals of Kolkata's Durga Puja, Navratri demonstrates how unity can coexist with diversity. Moreover, it **rejuvenates** social bonds, uniting strangers in a shared rhythm that no **hierarchy** can disturb.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, Navratri is a powerful reminder that our **heritage** is not a museum piece to be admired from a distance, but a living inspiration to be practised. If we cultivate the **resilience** of Durga, the humility of her devotees and the inclusiveness of her celebrations, we shall honour this tradition in the truest sense. I thank you for your gracious attention and wish you all a joyous and meaningful Navratri.

Word count: 293 words

CEFR C1 / C2 WORDS USED – ENGLISH & HINDI

#	Word	CEFR	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	myriad	C2	A very large number of different things	असंख्य / अनगिनत
2	profound	C1	Very deep, strong or serious in effect	गहन / गंभीर
3	vibrant	C1	Full of energy, life and bright colour	जीवंत / ऊर्जावान
4	spectacle	C1	An impressive and dramatic public show or sight	भव्य दृश्य / तमाशा
5	converge	C2	To come together from different directions and meet	एक स्थान पर मिलना / अभिसरण करना
6	venerate	C2	To respect and honour someone or something deeply	श्रद्धा से पूजना / अत्यंत सम्मान देना
7	embody	C1	To be a perfect example or expression of an idea	साकार करना / मूर्त रूप देना
8	unwavering	C2	Steady and firm; not changing or doubting	अटल / अडिग
9	perpetuate	C2	To make something continue for a long time	क्रायम रखना / जारी रखना
10	reverence	C2	A feeling of deep respect and awe	श्रद्धा / पूज्य भाव
11	transcend	C2	To go beyond the limits of something	सीमाओं से परे जाना / अतिक्रमण करना
12	personify	C2	To be a living example of a quality; to represent it in human form	मूर्त रूप होना / साकार करना
13	triumph	C1	A great victory or success	महान विजय / जीत
14	transient	C2	Lasting only for a short time	क्षणिक / अस्थायी
15	kaleidoscope	C2	A constantly changing pattern of many colours or things	विविध रंगों का समूह / बहुरंगी मेल
16	rejuvenate	C2	To make someone or something feel fresh and young again	नवजीवन देना / फिर से तरोताज़ा करना
17	hierarchy	C1	A system that ranks people from high to low status	पदानुक्रम / ऊँच-नीच की व्यवस्था
18	heritage	C1	Traditions and values passed down from earlier generations	विरासत
19	resilience	C2	The ability to recover quickly from difficulty	लचीलापन / दृढ़ता से उबरने की क्षमता

VERSION 5 OF 5

Phrasal Verbs Edition · Maximum Phrasal Verbs

अधिकतम फ्रेज़ल वर्ब्स

Good morning, respected Principal, teachers and my dear friends.

INTRODUCTION

Every year, when autumn **comes around**, the whole country **looks forward to** Navratri. This nine-night festival **sets off** a wave of joy, and everyone **gets ready** to celebrate. Today I will **talk about** how this festival **brings people together** and **brings out** the best in us.

BODY

Preparations **start off** weeks before the festival. Families **clean up** their houses, **put up** colourful decorations and **set up** a small shrine for Goddess Durga. On the first day, many people **wake up** early and **carry out** the puja with great devotion. Some devotees **give up** meat, onion and garlic for nine days, while others **cut down on** their food or **go without** grain. Grandparents **hand down** old stories to the children, and the children **grow up** loving them.

In the evening, friends and neighbours **turn up** in traditional clothes. Girls **dress up** in bright chaniya cholis, and boys **put on** their kurtas. As soon as the music **starts up**, everyone **joins in**, and the dancing **goes on** until late at night. Even shy people **open up** and **take part in** the Garba. Nobody **stays out of** the circle, and even little children **keep up with** the rhythm.

The story behind Navratri **stands for** the victory of good over evil. When the demon Mahishasura **took over** the world, the gods **turned to** Durga for help. She **fought back** bravely and **wiped out** the demon on the tenth day. Her example teaches us never to **give in** to fear, to **stand up for** what is right and to **look up to** strong women.

CONCLUSION

To **wrap up**, Navratri teaches us to **look after** our families, to **reach out to** people in need and to **carry on** with hope even when life gets tough. So let us **keep up** these good values and **pass them on** to the next generation. Thank you for listening, and Happy Navratri!

Word count: 319 words

PHRASAL VERBS USED – ENGLISH & HINDI

#	Phrasal Verb	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	come around	To arrive again, as a regular event or season does	(समय/त्योहार का) फिर से आना
2	look forward to	To wait for something with pleasure	बेसब्री से इंतज़ार करना
3	set off	To cause something to start	शुरू करना / आरंभ कर देना
4	get ready	To prepare yourself or something	तैयार होना
5	talk about	To discuss a topic	के बारे में बात करना
6	bring together	To make people meet or unite	लोगों को एक साथ लाना
7	bring out	To show or develop a quality	(गुण) उभारना / सामने लाना
8	start off	To begin	शुरू होना
9	clean up	To make a place completely clean	साफ़-सफ़ाई करना
10	put up	To fix something in position, e.g. decorations	लगाना / टाँगना
11	set up	To arrange or establish something	स्थापित करना / व्यवस्था करना
12	wake up	To stop sleeping	जागना / उठना
13	carry out	To do or perform a task	संपन्न करना / पूरा करना
14	give up	To stop having or doing something	छोड़ देना / त्याग देना
15	cut down on	To reduce the amount of something	कम करना
16	go without	To live without something you usually have	बिना रहना / अभाव में रहना
17	hand down	To pass knowledge or customs to younger people	विरासत में देना / आगे सौंपना
18	grow up	To become an adult	बड़ा होना
19	turn up	To arrive or appear	आ पहुँचना / उपस्थित होना
20	dress up	To wear special or smart clothes	सज-धज कर तैयार होना
21	put on	To wear clothes	पहनना
22	start up	To begin to play or work	शुरू हो जाना (संगीत/मशीन)
23	join in	To become involved in an activity	शामिल हो जाना
24	go on	To continue	जारी रहना
25	open up	To become more relaxed and talk freely	खुल कर बात करना / संकोच छोड़ना
26	take part in	To be involved in an activity	हिस्सा लेना / भाग लेना
27	stay out of	To not get involved in something	से दूर रहना / अलग रहना
28	keep up with	To move or progress at the same speed as others	के साथ क़दम मिलाकर चलना
29	stand for	To represent or mean something	का प्रतीक होना / दर्शाना
30	take over	To take control of something	क्रब्ज़ा कर लेना / कमान सँभालना
31	turn to	To go to someone for help	(मदद के लिए) की ओर मुड़ना
32	fight back	To defend yourself when attacked	पलटवार करना / डट कर मुक़ाबला करना
33	wipe out	To destroy completely	पूरी तरह मिटा देना / नष्ट करना
34	give in	To stop resisting; to surrender	हार मान लेना / झुक जाना
35	stand up for	To support or defend something or someone	के पक्ष में खड़ा होना / डट कर समर्थन करना
36	look up to	To admire and respect someone	आदर करना / प्रशंसा की दृष्टि से देखना
37	wrap up	To finish or conclude	समाप्त करना / निष्कर्ष पर पहुँचना

38	look after	To take care of someone	देखभाल करना
39	reach out to	To contact someone to offer help	मदद के लिए हाथ बढ़ाना / संपर्क करना
40	carry on	To continue doing something	आगे बढ़ते रहना / जारी रखना
41	keep up	To continue at the same level	बनाए रखना
42	pass on	To give something to the next person or generation	आगे बढ़ाना / सौंप देना